

1. Interview Feedback

The user has considerable experience browsing websites, but was unfamiliar with the idea of a “pre-internet story” and had not encountered similar content before.

The first reaction was to increase the screen brightness. She paused for a few seconds on the opening page, which made me think that there might be too many visual elements competing for attention. The user mostly navigated by scrolling down and reading the entire page first, and only used the navigation links after finishing the story. This was generally consistent with how I expected the website to be used, but it suggested that the navigation could be placed at the end rather than at the beginning. One thing that surprised me was that the user did not click the two song links while reading. Instead, she finished the page and then went back to click them. She said they could already guess that the links would lead to music videos. This reminded me that users bring common web conventions and reading habits to a website, and designers should not assume that users have already followed or understood links introduced earlier in the page.

The user found the reading experience smooth, with clear text and a simple but interesting layout. She especially liked the different font sizes in the lyrics and the visual compositions made from text characters. The background music, “The Last Day of Nineteen,” was particularly memorable and matched the story well, helping create a more immersive reading experience. After reading, the user immediately asked whether the story was real. When I confirmed that it was, she reacted with surprise and curiosity. This suggested that the website successfully communicated the feeling of amazement that I wanted the audience to experience.

The main confusing element was the opening page. The user spent more time there than expected, possibly because the layout did not clearly communicate where to begin. The “Click Here!” music link was also unsuccessful because it opened another page, making it difficult to listen to the song while reading the story.

2. Revisions

Based on this feedback, I made several changes to simplify the experience and improve accessibility. First, I removed the “Click Here!” music link and kept the audio directly embedded on the page. This allows users to listen to the song without leaving the story and better supports the immersive experience that the user responded positively to. I also simplified and reorganized the opening area and moved the navigation to the end of the page, following the user's actual browsing behavior.

I also revised the HTML structure using semantic elements such as <header>, <main>, <nav>, <section>, <figure>, and <figcaption>. These elements make the organization of the page clearer and can help users of assistive technologies, especially screen reader users, build a mental map of the page and move between different sections more easily. I also added meaningful alt text to images and used lang="zh" to identify Chinese text within the primarily English webpage, so screen readers can interpret the language more accurately.

I improved the heading hierarchy by organizing the page with h1, h2, and h3 rather than relying only on visual styling. This follows the structural and organizational principles discussed in class and makes the content easier to scan. I also added font fallbacks so that if a preferred font is unavailable, the browser can use another readable font instead.

Finally, I revised the CSS to make images and other elements adapt to different screen

sizes instead of relying only on fixed widths. For example, images can scale within their containers, which helps prevent horizontal scrolling on smaller screens. These changes make the website more responsive while preserving the visual style of the original design.

One thing I was not completely satisfied with was the ASCII art. To make the website responsive and prevent horizontal scrolling on smaller screens, I added wrapping to the `<pre>` elements. However, this means that the original ASCII composition cannot always be displayed in the way I intended, especially on a phone screen. I would like to further explore ways to keep the visual effect of the ASCII art while still making the website accessible and responsive across different screen sizes.